



ELEC3609/9609 - Week 13

Lab

A3 Technical Interview

Each group will participate in a technical interview conducted by the tutors, focusing on your **deployment setup** and **security configurations** for Assignment 3.

Task Description

This lab session is a **technical interview** to assess your group's understanding of your **deployment** and **security setup** in A3. Tutors will ask questions about:

- Your **AWS deployment environment** and configuration decisions.
- Web server and backend setup (e.g., Nginx, uWSGI, HTTPS).
- Your implementation of key **security requirements** (authentication, permissions, firewall, HTTPS, etc.).
- Technical challenges or decisions encountered during deployment and hardening.

Be prepared to **explain, justify, and demonstrate** your deployment and security setup using a **live instance** and related configuration files.

Presentation Order and Time Allocation

To efficiently manage lab time, interviews and deployment checks will run **in parallel**.

Interview Flow

- Groups will be interviewed in **ascending group number order** (e.g., *Group 1* → *Group 2* → *Group 3* ...)

- When your group number is called, **bring your laptop** to the tutor's desk.
- Each group will have **10 minutes total**, answer questions on deployment & security

Parallel Deployment Check

- One tutor will conduct interviews at the tutor desk in ascending group order.
- At the same time, the **second tutor will move around the room** to test deployments.
- The second tutor will verify that your website is successfully deployed and functioning by interacting with it on your machine.

! INFO

Please have your laptop ready and your deployed website accessible before your turn.

Special Requests

If your group requires an earlier interview due to urgent circumstances, please inform tutors **before the lab begins**.

During Interview

- Ensure your group has:
 - A **deployed website running in one group member's AWS Learner Lab EC2 instance**.
 - Access to your **EC2 instance via terminal** (SSH).
 - Access to key configuration files such as `nginx.conf`, `uwsgi.ini`, and your Django settings.
- Be prepared to **demonstrate live** the deployment setup and security measures.
- Be respectful and quiet while other groups are being interviewed.
- All group members must attend and be prepared to answer.

Reminder

This interview is part of your final project mark and focuses on your **technical understanding of deployment and security**.

To prepare:

- **Practice accessing your EC2 instance** via command line.
- Make sure you can **locate and explain configuration files quickly** (many groups waste time here).
- If possible, **deploy your website on more than one member's AWS Learner Lab environment** as a backup in case your primary instance is down.
- Be familiar with how you implemented:
 - HTTPS, reverse proxy, uWSGI
 - SSH configuration and file permissions
 - Django production settings
 - Security hardening (e.g., limited DB permissions, disabled debug mode, cookie/JWT protection)

Credit

This lab content was authored and maintained by **Jiawen Wen**, with materials adapted from prior offerings and updated to align with 2026 delivery. All standards used in this lab (IEEE, ISO/IEC) are referenced for educational purposes under fair use and are available to enrolled students via the university's licensed repository.